

Afghanistan

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** 2004 **Usage:** National

*Black recalls
previous
flags used in
Afghanistan*



*Green
represents
Islam*

*The new arms
of Afghanistan*

Asia



Afghanistan has had a troubled history. This is shown by the no less than 14 distinct national flags it has used in the 20th and 21st centuries.

With the election of a democratic government in 2004, the present flag was adopted. Black, red, and green have been traditional in most Afghan flags. Black is from the first recognized Afghan flag; red is for bravery, and green for Islam. The white emblem in the center is the state coat of arms. This too is a traditional design.

The arms show the Muslim Mehrab, the niche which shows the direction to the Muslim Holy City of Mecca, and Minbar, the pulpit from which sermons are preached. These are shown within a traditional image of a mosque, flanked by two national flags and surrounded by a wreath of wheat and beneath a rising sun. Four inscriptions also appear.

ARMS OF AFGHANISTAN

*The Arabic inscription
"God is Great"*



*The Arabic inscription
reads: "There is no god but
Allah, and Muhammad is
the Prophet of Allah"*

*The name of Afghanistan
in Arabic script*

*The date 1298 in the
Muslim calendar (AD 1919),
is the date Afghanistan was
internationally recognized
as independent.*